

1. Microsoft's new MAI models

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-02T22:21:52+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/2/microsofts-new-models/#atom-everything>

Microsoft announced two new text LLMs this morning - MAI-Thinking-1 (reasoning, 1T parameters, 35B active, available to "select early partners") and MAI-Code-1-Flash (137B Parameters, 5B active, "purpose-built for GitHub Copilot and VS Code to deliver high performance and lower cost [...] rolling out to GitHub Copilot individual users in Visual Studio Code"). I've not been able to try either of them just yet. It's very interesting to see Microsoft releasing models with such low parameter counts, especially given how expensive larger models are to access right now. They claim MAI-Thinking-1 "is preferred to Sonnet 4.6 in our blind human side-by-side evaluations", which is impressive for a 35B model seeing as I frequently run models larger than that on my own laptop. (UPDATE: I got this entirely wrong, see note below.) Also of note : We trained [MAI-Thinking-1] from the ground up on enterprise grade, clean and commercially licensed data, without distillation from third-party models. And for MAI-Code-1-Flash as well: It is built end-to-end by Microsoft using clean and appropriately licensed data. I would very much like to learn more about this "appropriately licensed" data! Could the...

2. datasette-agent-micropython 0.1a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-02T19:28:36+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/2/datasette-agent-micropython/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-agent-micropython 0.1a0 I want Datasette Agent to be able to generate and execute Python code safely. This alpha is looking promising so far. GPT-5.5 has so far failed to break out of the sandbox! Tags: python , sandboxing , datasette , webassembly , datasette-agent

3. micropython-wasm 0.1a1

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-02T19:20:47+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/2/micropython-wasm/#atom-everything>

Release: micropython-wasm 0.1a1 Fixes for some limitations that emerged while I was trying to use this to build datasette-agent-micropython . Tags: python , sandboxing , webassembly

4. Meta Reportedly Has a Slew of New Smart Glasses Planned for This Year

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-02T21:54:43Z

Link: <https://gizmodo.com/meta-has-a-ridiculous-amount-of-smart-glasses-planned-for-this-year-2000765741>

James Pero, summarizing for Gizmodo this paywalled report by Jyoti Mann for The Information: But, wait, there's more: in addition to the fall releases, The Information reports that Meta also has a pair slated for December, codenamed ?Mojito VIP.? There are also two prototypes being tested in the fall, according to the report, including one called ?Artemis? and another called ?SSG,? which is short for ?supersensing glasses.? The Information previously reported that the ?supersensing? pair would have always-on cameras capable of looking at your surroundings without you having to prompt the voice assistant or activate the camera with a button. The idea here is that, with a constant stream of visual information, the smart glasses could be a kind of ambient virtual assistant that remembers where you left your keys or other vision-based reminders. Spitball: Meta's entire business is predicated on knowing as much about people as possible. Their interest in building out a virtual ?metaverse? world was motivated by the fact they could track everything people do, see, say, and hear there. That didn't play out so they're pivoting to building out devices that will let them track everything pe...

5. Apple, the Anti-?Metaverse? VR Company

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-02T20:48:08Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2025/12/meta_says_fuck_that_metaverse_shit

One more bit of ?metaverse fever dream ? follow-up. The one company in the field that Nick Heer doesn't mention is Apple, makers of the best-known (albeit not best-selling) virtual reality headset. Think and say what you want about the Vision platform (I still think it's the first inning of a long game), but no one at Apple ever once gave a hint of endorsing ?metaverse? hype. In fact, as I've noted before , at a 2022 WSJ event, seven months before Vision Pro was announced and over a year before it was released, Joanna Stern asked Greg Joswiak and Craig Federighi : Stern: You have to finish this sentence, both of you. The metaverse is... Joz: A word I'll never use. ?Fever dream? is right. ?

6. The Metaverse Was Snake Oil for Isolation

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-02T20:42:33Z

Link: <https://daringfireball.net/linked/2026/06/01/the-metaverse-fever-dream>

A follow-up point from my post yesterday linking to Nick Heer's blockbuster ? The Metaverse Fever Dream ?. In particular, the connection Heer draws between the rise of ?metaverse? hype and the pandemic. I always sort of knew that metaverse hype roughly coincided with the Covid lockdown and our collective period of isolation and loneliness, a year-plus stretch when we relied mostly on computer platforms for nearly all socializing. But here in 2026 it's now clear that metaverse hype and lockdown-induced isolation exactly coincided. They didn't roughly overlap; they exactly overlapped. So much so that I'm now wondering if any of the ?metaverse? hype would have happened if Covid hadn't happened. Facebook still likely would've renamed itself, because they'd so poisoned the ?Facebook? brand itself , but maybe to something other than ?Meta? . We allowed the necessary initial emergency lockdown to extend indefinitely because it seemed like maybe we could get by for a long stretch using technology. The extended lockdown never would have happened if the Covid pandemic had broken out 20 or more years earlier. In 2020 and 2021, we could squint and say, sure, maybe kids can ?go to school? via...

7. Logic for Programmers extra credits

Source: Computer Things | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 14:48:48 +0000

Link: <https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/logic-for-programmers-extra-credits/>

So I said there wasn't a proper newsletter this week, since I'm in Budapest prepping for a conference. But I still got a thing for y'all. There's a lot of interesting topics I wanted to cover for Logic for Programmers , but the book is dense enough as it is and many of these were too tangential or technical to fit in well. So I've been writing some supplements and uploading them here . I've got four so far: How we compute the number of orderings of multiple concurrent processes How first-order logic can quantify over ?a set of functions?, what a ?set of functions? looks like, and how functions can be defined in terms of sets (plus a bit on currying and type theory) Barbara Liskov's ?history rule? in subtyping Total and partial orders on sets. Now I'm going to caveat that these were written off the cuff and haven't gone through the obsessive editing of the book itself, so they may be rough and there might be errors in them. Still, it's like 2-3000 words of math content, so hopefully covers not having a proper newsletter this time. Seeya next week!

8. Pluralistic: The tedious power of storytelling (02 Jun 2026) must-we-pretend

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 09:18:16 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/06/02/must-we-pretend/>

Today's links The tedious power of storytelling: "Excitement" is to art as "falsifiability" is to science. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Lost Marx Bros musical; USPTO v Drumpf trademark; 3D scans v copyright; Giving worse internet to people with bad credit ratings; Class action over royalty theft; Trusbusting Prime; Trusbusting Google. Upcoming appearances: London, Kansas City, LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Edinburgh, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. The tedious power of storytelling (permalink) Yesterday, I attended a Brian Eno talk about the nature of

creativity and art based on What Art Does, the short book he published with Bette Adriaanse last year: <https://www.faber.co.uk/product/9780571395514-what-art-does-an-unfinished-theory/> I haven't read the book (yet ? I just ordered a copy), but the talk really got me fizzing. The subject matter (not just what art does, but also what art is) is one I've given a lot of thought to, and Eno's characteristic mix of gnomic koans and deceptively plainspoken asse...

9. An Ode to the Exacting Pedantry of Computers

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/pedantry-of-computing/>

The very first computer programming class I ever took introduced me to the idea of there being different kinds of numbers, like integers, floats, and doubles (it was a C++ course). ?You mean, when I assign a variable, I have to say up front what kind of number this is?? It was such an odd concept to me. A number is a number. Why do I have to say it?s this kind of number or that kind of number? I dropped out of that class. A few years later, I decided I wanted to try programming again. So I took another intro class. This time they were teaching with Python instead of C++, so you can imagine my excitement to learn that I didn?t have to think of numbers in this way anymore! It felt like the computer was meeting me partway. Over time, I came to learn how pedantic computers are. They require a kind of exacting precision in saying what you want them to do. And they?ll only ever do exactly what you tell them to do, nothing more, nothing less. If there was a bug in your program, that wasn?t because the computer was doing something you told it not to. The computer was only ever doing exactly what you told it to do. A ?bug? was very likely a flaw in your conception of how the program should...

10. AI Doesn't Have ROI

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 14:04:43 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/ai-doesnt-have-roi/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter. It?s \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that?s usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA , Anthropic and

11. Is the Monaco Grand Prix decided at qualifying?

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/is-monaco-decided-at-qualifying>

A Formula One driver triggered my fact-checkitis. They claimed that Winning the Monaco Grand Prix in Monte Carlo is determined nine out of ten times by which position one starts in. That makes intuitive sense, because the Monte Carlo track is a narrow street track with few opportunities for overtakes. But ? really? Is that an off-the-cuff remark or an accurate statistical prediction of the race? (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

12. I went on the Built for Turbulence podcast

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/built-for-turbulence-podcast/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

I joined Radical's Built for Turbulence podcast to talk about what AI agents are doing to the economics of software, the Figma Trap, and why running human-written code without AI audit is going to start looking reckless.

13. Should C Programmers learn C++, Go or Rust?

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Mon, 30 Jul 2018 14:35:51 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/cpp-rust-go/>

I recently wrote a series of posts called ?Modern C++ for C Programmers?. I mentioned in the introduction: ?I hope to convince C programmers to give ?2017 era C++? (which is entirely unlike 2003 C++) another good look. (?) My goal is that when you go look for a new language to learn (say, Go or Rust), you will hopefully consider modern C++ as well.? Over the weeks as I posted new parts, I was blown away by the interest.

14. Modern C++ for C Programmers: introduction

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 28 Jul 2018 13:29:55 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/cpp-intro/>

2018 is an exciting time to be a programmer, with so many good ?full service? programming languages to choose from: C, C++ 2017, Go, Python, Rust and who knows Swift too. Programming languages are complicated beasts - even the simplest languages have specifications that run (or would run) in the hundreds of pages, and once you include everything, no serious language is likely to clock in under a thousand. With this comes the fact that every programming language has good parts, and frequently even more bad parts.

15. Modern C++ for C Programmers: Part 5

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 25 Jul 2018 11:26:51 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/cpp-5/>

Welcome back! In part 4 we went over the nitty-gritty of lambdas and how to store them, we explored the relation between the various C++ algorithms and containers, plus we took a stroll through some non-standard containers with exceptional capabilities. Note: part 1 is here. In this probably final part 5, we'll be going over some of the most powerful stuff in modern C++: ?perfect? reference counting and the concept of `std::move`.